SEBASTIAN FISHER COACHING

BUILDING PHASE

16-WEEK HYPERTROPHY PROGRAMME

COMPOUND-FIRST · PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD · NO FLUFF

PROGRAMME OVERVIEW

This is a 16-week structured hypertrophy programme built for intermediate-to-advanced lifters who want to add lean mass. Four training days per week. Every session is built around compound lifts with strategic accessory work. Volume increases across 4-week mesocycles, with a deload in week 4, 8, 12, and an intensity peak in weeks 13-16.

Training split: Upper / Lower / Upper / Lower (4 days/week)
Session length: 60-75 minutes
Equipment needed: Barbell, dumbbells, cables, pull-up bar
Rest days: Wednesday, Saturday, Sunday (recommended)

HOW TO USE THIS PROGRAMME

1. Track every session in a logbook — write sets, reps, and weight used.
2. Progressive overload: add 2.5kg to compounds or 1 rep each week where possible.
3. RPE targets are given. RPE 8 = 2 reps left in the tank. RPE 9 = 1 rep left.
4. Deload weeks: reduce all working weights by 40%, keep rep ranges the same.
5. Nutrition: aim for a 300-500kcal surplus. Minimum 1.8g protein per kg bodyweight.

WEEKS 1-4 — FOUNDATION BLOCK

DAY 1 — UPPER A (PUSH FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Flat Barbell Bench Press	4	6-8	8	3 min
Overhead Press	3	8-10	8	2.5 min
Incline Dumbbell Press	3	10-12	8	2 min
Cable Lateral Raise	3	12-15	9	90 sec
Tricep Pushdowns	3	12-15	9	90 sec
Overhead Tricep Extension	2	12-15	9	90 sec

DAY 2 — LOWER A (SQUAT FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Back Squat	4	6-8	8	3 min
Romanian Deadlift	3	8-10	8	2.5 min
Leg Press	3	10-12	9	2 min
Walking Lunges	3	10/leg	8	2 min
Leg Curl (Seated or Lying)	3	12-15	9	90 sec
Standing Calf Raises	4	12-15	9	90 sec

DAY 3 — UPPER B (PULL FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Barbell Row (Overhand)	4	6-8	8	3 min
Weighted Pull-Ups	3	6-10	8	2.5 min

Seated Cable Row	3	10-12	8	2 min
Face Pulls	3	15-20	8	90 sec
Barbell Curl	3	10-12	9	90 sec
Hammer Curls	2	12-15	9	90 sec

DAY 4 — LOWER B (DEADLIFT FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Conventional Deadlift	4	5-6	8	3-4 min
Front Squat	3	8-10	8	2.5 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3	10/leg	8	2 min
Hip Thrust	3	10-12	9	2 min
Leg Extension	3	12-15	9	90 sec
Seated Calf Raises	4	15-20	9	90 sec

WEEKS 5-8 — VOLUME BLOCK

Same exercises as Weeks 1-4. Increase working sets by 1 on all compound movements. Add one extra accessory set where tolerable. Target: push RPE to 8-9 on all working sets.

CHANGES FROM WEEKS 1-4:

- All compound lifts: +1 working set (e.g. 4 sets becomes 5)
- Accessory work: +1 set where recovery allows
- RPE targets increase: compounds at RPE 8-9, accessories at RPE 9
- Week 8 = DELOAD: reduce all weights by 40%, keep rep ranges

WEEKS 9-12 — INTENSITY RAMP

Drop back to Week 1-4 set counts but increase weight. Target heavier loads with controlled reps. Introduce intensity techniques on final sets.

CHANGES FROM WEEKS 5-8:

- Return to base set count (Week 1-4 volumes)
- Increase load by 5-10% across all compounds
- Final set of each compound: push to RPE 9-9.5
- Accessories: add drop set on final set of each exercise
- Week 12 = DELOAD: reduce all weights by 40%

WEEKS 13-16 — PEAK BLOCK

Final 4 weeks. Highest intensity of the programme. Compounds driven heavy with low reps on key sets. Accessories maintain volume for pump and metabolic stress.

CHANGES FROM WEEKS 9-12:

- Compound top sets: RPE 9-10 (near-maximal effort)
- Add back-off set after top set: -15% weight, same reps
- Accessory work: maintain Week 9-12 volume + intensity techniques
- Week 16: test new rep maxes on Bench, Squat, Deadlift, OHP

TRAINING LOG TEMPLATE

Print this page or copy the format into a notebook. One row per exercise, one column per week.

EXERCISE	WK 1	WK 2	WK 3	WK 4
Bench Press	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD
OHP	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD
Back Squat	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD
Deadlift	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD
Barbell Row	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD
Front Squat	___kg x___	___kg x___	___kg x___	DELOAD

Format: Write weight (kg) x reps achieved. E.g. "100kg x 7". If you hit the top of the rep range at RPE 8, increase weight next session by 2.5kg (upper) or 5kg (lower).

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